

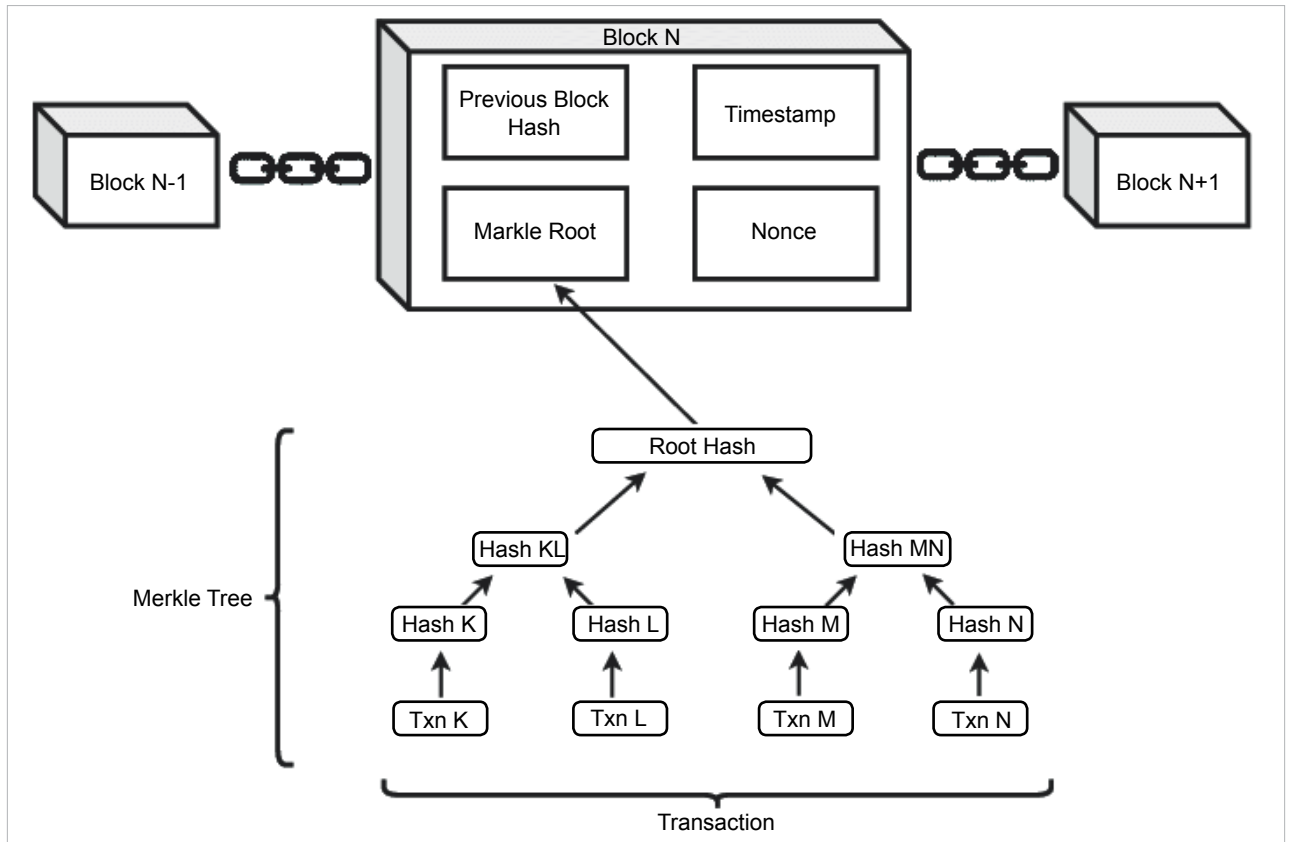


Figure 1: Structure of an Ethereum blockchain (Credit: *researchgate.net*)

development of interoperability solutions, bridging different blockchains and promoting seamless asset transfers.

The genesis of Ethereum

Ethereum traces its origins to the visionary mind of Vitalik Buterin in 2013. Recognising the limitations of Bitcoin, Buterin penned the Ethereum whitepaper, envisioning a blockchain that could go beyond mere digital currency. He visualised a versatile and open platform that could support smart contracts and a wide array of decentralised applications.

Buterin's vision ignited a call to action, rallying a global community of developers, including figures like Gavin Wood and Joseph Lubin, who shared his belief in Ethereum's potential. In 2015, Ethereum's genesis block marked the official beginning of a new era in blockchain technology, where developers could build decentralised applications that extended far beyond the boundaries of digital currency. This genesis moment unleashed a wave of innovation and inspired a worldwide movement.

The genesis of Ethereum serves as a testament to the power of visionary thinking, open source collaboration, and the boundless possibilities of blockchain. It not only birthed a blockchain but sparked a global movement, inspiring developers, entrepreneurs, and blockchain enthusiasts to

reimagine what decentralised technology could achieve. Ethereum's journey from a whitepaper to a thriving ecosystem is a testament to the enduring impact of bold ideas and the transformative potential of blockchain technology on a global scale.

Ethereum's open source philosophy

Ethereum's foundation is built upon a bedrock of open source philosophies. From its inception, Ethereum championed transparency, collaboration, and community involvement as fundamental tenets. The source code of Ethereum's client software, such as Geth and Parity, is accessible to the public, inviting scrutiny and contributions from developers worldwide. This unwavering commitment to transparency ensures the Ethereum network remains secure and free from hidden vulnerabilities.

However, Ethereum's dedication to open source transcends mere code accessibility. It fosters a global community of developers and advocates who work harmoniously to continually enhance the platform. This community values inclusivity, welcoming developers of all backgrounds to contribute their expertise to the network's growth. It is this spirit of collaboration that defines Ethereum's open source philosophy.